CHEAT SHEET

Caching on Vercel: one-page cheat sheet

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Four layers, from closest to the user outwards. Pick the outermost one that is safe for the data.

LAYER	HOLDS	WHERE	USE FOR	CLEARED BY
`use cache: private`	Rendered output for one person	The browser's router memory	Personal pages: my trips, my account	The `stale` time, a reload, a Server Action
CDN cache	Whole responses	Each Vercel region	APIs and pages that are the same for everyone	`s-maxage`, purge by tag
ISR	Whole pages, durably	The function region, behind the CDN	Content: products, destinations, articles	Time-based or on-demand revalidation (about 300 ms globally)
Runtime Cache (`use cache: remote`)	Data: fetches, queries	Each region, shared by functions	Expensive or rate-limited lookups	TTL, `updateTag` / `revalidateTag`

Rules of thumb

- Nothing with `Set-Cookie`, `Authorization` or `Vary: Cookie` is cached at the CDN.
- Gate access in Routing Middleware (`proxy.ts`): it runs before the cache, so the page can stay cached.
- `stale` needs at least 30 seconds for prefetching and 5 minutes to join the App Shell.
- Prove it in a demo with `x-vercel-cache`: MISS, then HIT.

SA Team Hub demo asset library. People and customers are fictional.